Multi-Instance OpenClaw Setup Guide

For: Michael K C Lim — Household with Multiple OpenClaw Bots
Created: April 3, 2026
Purpose: Run multiple OpenClaw instances without gateway conflicts

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⚠️ The Problem

Two OpenClaw instances in same household = **gateway port conflict**

Both try to use:

- Port: `18789`
- Bind: `loopback` (127.0.0.1)

Result: Second instance can't connect.

✅ Solution: Different Ports

Instance	Device	Port	Status
Primary	Mac mini (Subhuti)	18789	✅ Keep as-is
Secondary	Windows PC	18790	⚙️ Change to this

🛠️ On Windows OpenClaw

Step 1: Stop Gateway

```
openclaw gateway stop
```

Step 2: Edit Config File

Location:

```
C:\Users\<Username>\.openclaw\openclaw.json
```

Find this section:

```
"gateway": {
  "bind": "loopback",
  "mode": "local",
  "port": 18789
}
```

Change to:

```
"gateway": {
  "bind": "loopback",
  "mode": "local",
  "port": 18790
}
```

Step 3: Restart Gateway

```
openclaw gateway start
```

Step 4: Verify

```
openclaw status
```

Or test directly:

```
curl http://127.0.0.1:18790
```

Should return gateway info (not "connection refused").

📋 PowerShell Automation Script

Copy-paste this into Windows PowerShell:

```
# Stop gateway
openclaw gateway stop

# Backup config
Copy-Item ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json.bak

# Edit port
$config = Get-Content ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json -Raw | ConvertFrom-Json
$config.gateway.port = 18790
$config | ConvertTo-Json -Depth 10 | Set-Content ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json

# Restart
openclaw gateway start

# Verify
openclaw status

Write-Host "✅ Gateway now running on port 18790"
```

🪷 Recommended: Different Identities

Avoid confusion between bots:

Aspect	Mac (Primary)	Windows (Secondary)
Name	Subhuti	Ananda (or other)
Emoji	🪷	🌟
Telegram Bot	@SubhutiBot	@AnandaBot (create new)
Workspace	`~/.openclaw/workspace`	Separate directory
Memory	Separate MEMORY.md	Separate MEMORY.md

Why Different Identities?

- ✅ No message confusion (which bot is which?)
- ✅ No memory bleeding
- ✅ No identity conflicts
- ✅ Clear separation of concerns

🔍 Troubleshooting

Windows Firewall Blocking

```
# Allow port through firewall
netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="OpenClaw 18790" dir=in action=allow protocol=TCP localport=18790
```

Port Still in Use

```
# Check what's using the port
netstat -ano | findstr :18790

# Kill the process if needed
taskkill /PID <PID> /F
```

Workspace Conflicts

Ensure each instance has **separate workspace**:

Windows config:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "workspace": "C:\\Users\\<Username>\\.openclaw\\workspace"
  }
}
```

Mac config:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "workspace": "/Volumes/Subhuti Main/openclaw-workspace"
  }
}
```

📊 Port Assignment Table

For future expansion:

Instance	Device	Location	Port
Subhuti	Mac mini	Living room	18789
Ananda	Windows PC	Office	18790
Future 1	Raspberry Pi	Bedroom	18791
Future 2	Laptop	Mobile	18792

✅ Final Checklist

After setup, verify:

- [ ] Mac bot responds on port 18789
- [ ] Windows bot responds on port 18790
- [ ] Both can run simultaneously
- [ ] Separate workspaces (no file conflicts)
- [ ] Separate Telegram bots (if using)
- [ ] Separate memory files

🙏 Notes

This setup allows:

- ✅ Multiple bots in same household
- ✅ No gateway conflicts
- ✅ Independent operation
- ✅ Easy to add more instances

Each bot should have:

- Unique port
- Unique workspace
- Unique identity (name, emoji, Telegram bot)

- Independent memory

Created with care for Michael's multi-bot household. 🪷

Last updated: April 3, 2026